

ENGLISH FOR RESTAURANT TEAMS

Restaurant Serving English

Clear orders. Confident service.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.



Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For restaurant servers, food runners, section leads, and guest-facing food-service teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight service conversations: clarify an order, compare menu prices, receive an allergy question, explain a delay, correct a dish, split a bill, agree on clearing, and hand over a live section.

01 Confirming seats and order details

4

Who asked for no onions? | Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

02 Explaining menu choices and prices

13

The steak set or steak alone? | Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

03 Receiving an allergy question

22

Checking the bun before ordering | Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

04 Coordinating courses and delays

31

Eight more minutes? | Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

05 Correcting a dish without blame

40

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered | Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

06 Explaining and splitting a bill

49

What does three ways mean? | Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

07 Agreeing on clearing and shared service

58

An empty plate still in use | Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

08 Handing over a live section

67

Two tables, two unfinished tasks | Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

Communication field notes

3

Answers and explanations

76

Fast-access phrase pages

92

Vocabulary index

94

Sources and publication notes

102

Warm service. Precise details.

Good service depends on listening closely while several things happen at once. Move between friendly guest-facing language and concise kitchen messages. Keep the table, seat, dish, request, timing, and responsible person clear.

Ask one useful question

A short clarification can prevent a long correction. Repeat the exact detail that is unclear and ask the guest to attach it to a person or dish. Do not turn an unidentified modifier into a table-wide instruction.

"Which dish should have no onions?"

Translate kitchen shorthand

Colleagues may say fire, covers, or on the fly. Guests need a clear explanation of their meal. Use internal shorthand only when the listener understands its local meaning.

"The kitchen estimates another eight minutes for your mains."

Show the complete comparison

A set price and an individual dish price are not interchangeable. Name what each includes before describing the difference. A supplement increases the stated base; it is not a replacement price.

"The steak set is \$29 with dessert; steak alone is \$27 without dessert."

Own the next step

An apology is more useful when followed by a specific action within your authority. Separate a replacement offer from an approved bill adjustment, and transfer live queries to a named colleague.

"I can offer the remake; the shift lead needs to review any bill adjustment."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All restaurants, prices, guests, and service events are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, or payment compliance. Follow current local law and actual allergy, food-handling, payment, and emergency procedures. Menu descriptions do not establish allergen safety. Do not delay urgent help for a routine service conversation.

Who asked for no onions?

A Read the situation

Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

At fictional table 12, three guests are ordering. Seat one wants mushroom pasta; seat two wants salad with dressing separately; seat three has not chosen. Someone says "no onions," but server Lena cannot tell which dish the request belongs to. She has not sent the order. Guest Sam at seat two confirms during the conversation that the onion request belongs to the salad. Seat three still needs time. No allergy is reported in this case, and the onion request must not be treated as a confirmed allergy or a rule for every dish.

PEOPLE / Lena: Server | Sam: Guest at seat two

CLARIFICATION IS PART OF ATTENTION

A guest may speak while another person is ordering, or answer on behalf of someone else. A brief, neutral check avoids blame and keeps the exchange moving. Say which detail needs clarification rather than asking the whole table to repeat everything.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which seat has not chosen?

A Seat two

C Seat three

B All three seats

D Seat one

2. Which request already belongs to the salad?

A Dressing mixed through the salad

C No mushrooms in the pasta

B Dressing separately

D A completed third main

3. What should Lena clarify before sending?

A Whether every guest dislikes all vegetables

C Whether there are four covers

B Whether the pasta was already served

D Which dish should have no onions

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cover

One diner counted for restaurant service or planning.

IN USE serve three covers

seat number

Identifier linking an order to a place at a table.

IN USE confirm the seat number

table number

Identifier used to locate a dining table.

IN USE check the table number

order pad

Written surface used to record guest orders.

IN USE update the order pad

point of sale

System for entering orders and recording sales, often abbreviated POS.

IN USE enter the order at the point of sale

order ticket

Record of dishes and instructions sent for preparation.

IN USE read the order ticket

modifier

Instruction changing an item from its standard preparation or presentation.

IN USE attach a modifier

omission

Requested removal of an ingredient or component.

IN USE confirm the omission

substitution

Replacement of one component with another when available and permitted.

IN USE check a substitution

on the side

Served separately rather than mixed into or placed on the dish.

IN USE serve dressing on the side

read-back

Spoken repetition of recorded details to check accuracy.

IN USE give a read-back

seat reference

Link showing which guest a detail concerns.

IN USE clarify the seat reference

Precision check

No onions needs a clear dish reference. Do not attach it to every plate because the speaker was unclear. A modifier describes the requested change; a reported allergy requires its own accurate communication and the actual allergy process.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

course

Stage of a meal, such as a starter or main.

IN USE enter the main course

main

Principal dish in a meal.

IN USE choose a main

starter

Dish served before the main course in the relevant menu format.

IN USE order a starter

garnish

Item added to finish or accompany a dish.

IN USE identify the garnish

accompaniment

Food served alongside a principal item.

IN USE describe the accompaniment

preparation request

Guest instruction about how an item should be prepared.

IN USE confirm the preparation request

dietary requirement

Food-related need that must be described accurately and handled appropriately.

IN USE clarify a dietary requirement

preference

Stated choice that must not automatically be labeled a medical condition.

IN USE record a preference

pending choice

Selection that has not yet been made.

IN USE keep a choice pending

send the order

Transmit a confirmed order through the restaurant's system.

IN USE send the order

order sequence

Agreed order in which information or dishes are handled.

IN USE preserve the order sequence

confirmation

Explicit agreement that repeated details are correct.

IN USE obtain confirmation

Precision check

Seat three has not chosen is not the same as seat three is not eating. Confirmed items and pending choices can coexist. Follow the restaurant process for sending partial orders, but never invent a third dish to complete a ticket.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE DISH

"Which dish should have no onions?"

READ BACK SEAT ONE

"Seat one is the mushroom pasta."

PRESERVE THE PENDING CHOICE

"Seat three is still deciding."

AVOID A TABLE-WIDE CHANGE

"I will not apply that request to the other dishes."

CHECK THE GUEST

"Is that request for your salad?"

READ BACK SEAT TWO

"Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side."

ATTACH THE MODIFIER

"I will put no onions on the salad request."

ASK BRIEFLY

"May I check one detail before I send this?"

Which dish

Targets the missing reference instead of questioning the guest's reason.

Still deciding

Describes an unfinished choice without canceling the meal.

On the side

Common serving phrase meaning separately.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

TRANSLATE SEPARATELY

"The dressing will be requested on the side."

KEEP THE RECORD ALIGNED

"The seat reference and modifier need to stay together."

CONFIRM UNDERSTANDING

"Have I matched the dishes and requests correctly?"

KEEP TRANSMISSION ACCURATE

"The order has not been sent yet."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND GUARANTEE

"I will confirm any preparation question through our kitchen process."

AVOID AN INVENTED ALLERGY

"No allergy has been reported in this exchange."

ALLOW TIME

"I will give seat three another moment to choose."

CLOSE WITH THE CORRECTED DETAIL

"Salad for seat two, no onions, dressing on the side."

Put on the request

Refers to recording the instruction, not adding onions to the food.

Yet

Distinguishes an unsent order from one already in preparation.

Matched correctly

Invites correction before an avoidable error moves to the kitchen.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is most useful?
 - A Which dish should have no onions?
 - B Why did everyone speak so badly?
 - C Should I remove every vegetable from every plate?
 - D Shall I invent something for seat three?

2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?
 - A No mushrooms in every dish
 - B Dressing mixed through all dishes
 - C Cancel seat three's meal
 - D No onions, dressing on the side

3. Which statement preserves the pending choice?
 - A Seat three ordered mushroom pasta.
 - B Seat three is not eating.
 - C All three mains are confirmed.
 - D Seat three is still deciding.

4. What does the onion request establish medically?
 - A No allergy diagnosis or report by itself
 - B A confirmed onion allergy for all diners
 - C That no allergy process is ever needed
 - D That all foods are safe

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Who asked for no onions?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seat reference / confirmation / send the order / pending choice / covers / omission / read-back / on the side / modifier / order ticket

- 01 **Lena:** Before I send your order, may I check one detail? I heard no onions while the other dish was being discussed, but I did not catch which dish that was for.
- 02 **Sam:** That was for my salad. I am in seat two. Please keep the ¹ _____ with that dish, not with the mushroom pasta.
- 03 **Lena:** Thank you. I have mushroom pasta for seat one and salad for seat two. You also asked for the dressing separately, is that right?
- 04 **Sam:** Yes, dressing ² _____. I would like to add it myself. The no-onions request is also mine, so those two details belong together.
- 05 **Lena:** That is clear now. Seat three has not chosen a main yet, so I have not added a dish for that person.
- 06 **Sam:** Correct. Please leave that as a ³ _____. We were comparing the options, and I do not want my request to sound like an order for everyone.
- 07 **Lena:** Of course. I will check with seat three separately. Let me repeat the confirmed details so you can tell me if I have missed anything.
- 08 **Sam:** A quick ⁴ _____ would help. It was noisy when we were speaking, and I would rather correct the reference now than when the plates arrive.
- 09 **Lena:** Seat one, mushroom pasta. Seat two, salad with no onions and dressing on the side. Seat three is still deciding. Have I matched those correctly?
- 10 **Sam:** Yes. That ⁵ _____ is right. The pasta stays as ordered; the salad is the one with the two requests.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Lena:** Good. I will make sure the dish and its instructions stay together in our system. I have not transmitted the order yet.
- 12 **Sam:** Thank you. I know a short note can look different on an ⁶ _____ if the request is not linked to the right item.
- 13 **Lena:** Exactly. I am checking the wording before it reaches the kitchen. I will also follow our process if any preparation detail needs further confirmation.
- 14 **Sam:** That makes sense. We have three ⁷ _____, but only two main-course choices so far. Please do not treat the number of diners as three completed orders.
- 15 **Lena:** I will keep those separate. I also will not add an allergy note that no one has reported. If you have a dietary requirement, please tell me directly.
- 16 **Sam:** Understood. The current ⁸ _____ is no onions in my salad. I can see why the exact wording matters when you pass it to the kitchen.
- 17 **Lena:** I will give seat three another moment, then check the remaining choice. There is no need for you to decide on that person's behalf.
- 18 **Sam:** Good. Once that person chooses, you can complete the ⁹ _____ with them. I have confirmed only the details that belong to me.
- 19 **Lena:** Thank you. I now have the salad request attached correctly, and the mushroom pasta remains unchanged. I will check the third choice next.
- 20 **Sam:** Thank you. Please check that last choice before you ¹⁰ _____. I will leave seat three to tell you what they would like.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. modifier | 2. on the side | 3. pending choice | 4. read-back | 5. seat reference | 6. order ticket | 7. covers | 8. omission | 9. confirmation | 10. send the order

Attach a different request

F Say it

Table 8 has two covers. Seat one orders tomato soup; seat two orders grilled fish. A lemon-separately request is clarified as belonging to the fish. No third diner or allergy is reported.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

covers / two / fish / unchanged

Server: "The lemon request belongs to the ¹ _____."

Guest: "That is seat ² _____."

Server: "The tomato soup remains ³ _____."

Guest: "There are two ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. fish | 2. two | 3. unchanged | 4. covers

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The steak set or steak alone?

A Read the situation

Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

The fictional lunch set is \$24 and includes a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds a \$5 supplement to that set price. The a la carte steak is \$27 without dessert. Both steak options include potatoes. Guest Jordan initially thinks the steak set must cost \$24, then wonders whether potatoes cost extra. Server Priya must compare the \$29 steak set with the \$27 steak alone, explain the two-dollar difference, and avoid inventing a separate dessert price, drink inclusion, or tax policy. No choice has been made at the start.

PEOPLE / Jordan: Lunch guest | Priya: Server

HELP THE GUEST COMPARE

A recommendation should explain a relevant difference without pressuring the guest or implying a more expensive option is always better. State the total for each option and its inclusions. Let the guest decide whether the added item is worth the difference.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the steak set price?

A \$24

B \$27

C \$32

D \$29

2. Which item is included in both steak options?

A A separate starter

B Potatoes

C Dessert

D Coffee

3. What is not supplied?

A The set base price

B The steak supplement

C The a la carte steak price

D A separate dessert price

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

set menu

Group of included courses offered for a stated price, subject to listed conditions.

IN USE explain the set menu

a la carte

Ordered as individual menu items rather than as a set.

IN USE order a la carte

supplement

Additional charge added to a stated base price.

IN USE apply the steak supplement

base price

Starting price before specified additions.

IN USE state the base price

inclusive price

Price covering the items or charges explicitly named as included.

IN USE explain the inclusive price

inclusion

Item or service covered by the quoted option.

IN USE compare the inclusions

exclusion

Item or charge not covered by an option.

IN USE clarify an exclusion

price difference

Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis.

IN USE calculate the price difference

standalone price

Price charged for an item bought separately.

IN USE verify the standalone price

upgrade

Change to a different or enhanced option, often at an added cost.

IN USE explain the upgrade

main-and-dessert set

Meal option combining a main course and dessert.

IN USE choose the main-and-dessert set

side dish

Food served alongside a principal dish.

IN USE include a side dish

Precision check

The \$5 supplement belongs to the \$24 set base: $\$24 + \$5 = \$29$. It is not added to the \$27 a la carte price. The comparison is \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert, with potatoes in both.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

portion

Amount served to one person or as specified.

IN USE describe the portion

menu description

Written account of a dish or offer.

IN USE read the menu description

daily special

Dish or offer identified as special for the relevant service period.

IN USE explain the daily special

availability

Whether an item can currently be ordered.

IN USE check availability

value comparison

Assessment of price alongside the contents or benefits of an option.

IN USE make a value comparison

additional charge

Amount payable beyond a specified quoted price.

IN USE identify an additional charge

price clarification

Explanation resolving uncertainty about what an amount means.

IN USE give a price clarification

itemized total

Sum showing the individual components that make up the charge.

IN USE present an itemized total

optional extra

Additional item that is not compulsory or automatically included.

IN USE describe an optional extra

menu pairing

Combination of items offered or suggested together.

IN USE explain the menu pairing

price basis

Items and conditions to which a quoted price applies.

IN USE state the price basis

guest choice

Selection made by the diner after receiving relevant information.

IN USE confirm the guest choice

Precision check

A two-dollar difference between these options does not establish that every dessert costs two dollars separately. Do not promise identical portions, included drinks, or an all-in bill total when those details are absent. Explain the menu prices actually supplied.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INTRODUCE THE SET

"The lunch set includes a main and dessert."

EXPLAIN THE ADDITION

"Steak carries a \$5 supplement on that set."

INTRODUCE THE ALTERNATIVE

"The a la carte steak is \$27."

KEEP SHARED INCLUSIONS CLEAR

"Both steak options include potatoes."

STATE THE BASE

"The set starts at \$24."

GIVE THE COMBINED PRICE

"That makes the steak set \$29."

NAME THE DIFFERENCE IN CONTENTS

"The a la carte option does not include dessert."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"The set is two dollars more than steak alone."

Starts at

Signals a base price that may change with a specified selection.

Carries a supplement

Common menu language for an added charge.

That makes

Introduces the result of a transparent calculation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED STANDALONE PRICE

"That difference is not a quoted separate dessert price."

DO NOT INVENT A SURCHARGE

"No extra potato charge is listed in these options."

AVOID PRESSURE

"It depends on whether you want the included dessert."

CONFIRM THE CHOSEN OPTION

"Let me confirm which option you would like."

RESPOND TO A PRICE MISUNDERSTANDING

"The \$24 is the base, before the steak supplement."

KEEP THE CHOICE OPEN

"Would you prefer the set with dessert or the steak alone?"

SEPARATE UNKNOWN DETAILS

"I would need to check any detail not stated on this menu."

SUMMARIZE EVENLY

"\$29 with dessert, or \$27 without dessert; potatoes are included in both."

Both

Prevents a shared inclusion from sounding exclusive to one option.

Two dollars more

Compares these options without assigning every component a standalone price.

Would you prefer

Gives the decision to the guest after the comparison.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which calculation is correct?

- A** $\$27 - \$24 = \$3$ for dessert
- B** $\$24 + \$5 = \$29$ for the steak set
- C** $\$27 + \$5 = \$32$ for the steak set
- D** $\$24 - \$5 = \$19$ for the steak set

2. Which comparison is complete?

- A** \$24 versus \$27 with identical inclusions
- B** \$29 without potatoes versus \$27 with potatoes
- C** \$5 versus \$27 for the entire meal
- D** \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert; both include potatoes.

3. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?

- A** Both steak options include potatoes.
- B** The restaurant's standalone dessert price is \$2.
- C** The steak set costs \$2 more.
- D** The set includes dessert.

4. Which recommendation avoids pressure?

- A** The set guarantees the largest portion.
- B** If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.
- C** Everyone must buy the set.
- D** The a la carte steak includes an unlisted free dessert.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The steak set or steak alone?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

main-and-dessert set / guest choice / supplement / price basis / price difference / base price / standalone price / inclusion / value comparison / a la carte

- 01 **Jordan:** Could you help me with the lunch menu? I saw twenty-four dollars beside the set, but there is another amount beside the steak.
- 02 **Priya:** Certainly. Twenty-four dollars is the ¹ _____ for a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds five dollars, so that particular set comes to twenty-nine.
- 03 **Jordan:** So the five dollars is on top of the set price, not the complete price of the steak and not a replacement for twenty-four?
- 04 **Priya:** Exactly. It is a ² _____ to the set. Twenty-four plus five is twenty-nine for the steak set, including dessert.
- 05 **Jordan:** I also see steak listed separately at twenty-seven. Is that another way of ordering the same main without taking the lunch set?
- 06 **Priya:** Yes, that is the ³ _____ option. The steak is twenty-seven without dessert. Both options include potatoes, so you do not need to add them to this comparison.
- 07 **Jordan:** That answers my next question. I thought perhaps the lower price meant that the steak came on its own and I would pay separately for potatoes.
- 08 **Priya:** Potatoes are a shared ⁴ _____ here. The difference stated on this menu is the dessert, alongside the two different menu prices.
- 09 **Jordan:** Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert.
- 10 **Priya:** That is the correct ⁵ _____. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Jordan:** Could I have the steak alone now and assume any dessert will cost two dollars later? That would let me decide after the main.
- 12 **Priya:** I would need to check the ⁶ _____ before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.
- 13 **Jordan:** Fair enough. I do not want to order on the basis of a price that is not actually listed. I just wanted to understand the options.
- 14 **Priya:** Of course. A useful ⁷ _____ depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.
- 15 **Jordan:** Is coffee included with the dessert in that set? I sometimes see that elsewhere, but I cannot find it in this description.
- 16 **Priya:** Coffee is not part of the stated ⁸ _____ in the details we are comparing. I would check its price and status separately rather than tell you it is part of the set.
- 17 **Jordan:** Understood. For now, I only need the menu price of the two steak options and what each one includes. You have made that much clearer.
- 18 **Priya:** Then the ⁹ _____ is twenty-nine for steak, potatoes, and the included dessert, or twenty-seven for steak and potatoes without dessert.
- 19 **Jordan:** I will take another moment to decide about dessert. Please do not enter the set just because we have spent longer discussing it.
- 20 **Priya:** Certainly. I will wait for your ¹⁰ _____. When you are ready, tell me set or a la carte, and I will confirm the option before entering it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. base price | 2. supplement | 3. a la carte | 4. inclusion | 5. price difference | 6. standalone price | 7. value comparison | 8. main-and-dessert set | 9. price basis | 10. guest choice

Compare another set

F Say it

A fictional main-and-dessert set has a \$20 base and a \$4 fish supplement. Fish alone costs \$22 without dessert. Both options include rice. No separate dessert price is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rice / twenty-two / unspecified / twenty-four

Server: "The fish set costs ¹ _____ dollars."

Guest: "Fish alone is ² _____ dollars."

Server: "Both options include ³ _____."

Guest: "The separate dessert price is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. twenty-four | 2. twenty-two | 3. rice | 4. unspecified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Checking the bun before ordering

A Read the situation

03

Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

At table 6, guest Eli reports a sesame allergy and asks whether the burger bun is suitable. Server Noor has an old menu description, not current ingredient or cross-contact information. Kitchen lead Cam is available to discuss the question before any order is sent. The conversation does not supply a verified bun ingredient list, a confirmed preparation arrangement, or a safe alternative. Noor must preserve the reported allergen, check the current product and handling information through the real allergy procedure, and avoid replacing an unanswered question with reassurance.

PEOPLE / Eli: Guest reporting a sesame allergy | Noor: Server

TAKE THE DISCLOSURE SERIOUSLY

Thank the guest for identifying the allergy and make the next step clear. Do not test whether the guest sounds serious enough or rely on how a product looks. The guest should hear what is known, what needs checking, and who is handling the question.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which allergen does Eli report?

A An unspecified dislike

C A general dislike of bread

B A confirmed milk allergy

D Sesame

2. What information does Noor hold?

A An old menu description

C A confirmed cross-contact assessment

B A verified current bun specification

D A guaranteed safe alternative

3. Who is available before an order is sent?

A Only a future supplier next month

C Another diner making a guess

B No responsible colleague

D Kitchen lead Cam

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

food allergy

Immune-system reaction to a food protein that can be serious.

IN USE report a food allergy

allergen

Substance capable of causing an allergic reaction in a susceptible person.

IN USE identify the allergen

sesame

Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States.

IN USE flag a sesame allergy

ingredient list

Record of substances intentionally used in a product.

IN USE check the current ingredient list

product specification

Detailed information describing a particular supplied food product.

IN USE verify the product specification

supplier label

Label information attached to or associated with a supplied product.

IN USE inspect the supplier label

recipe

Specified ingredients and method for making a dish.

IN USE check the current recipe

cross-contact

Unintended introduction of an allergen into another food.

IN USE assess allergen cross-contact

shared equipment

Equipment used for more than one food or preparation.

IN USE check shared equipment

preparation area

Place where food is handled or assembled.

IN USE verify the preparation area

allergen matrix

Structured record showing allergen information across relevant menu items.

IN USE consult the current allergen matrix

current product

Actual product presently used, which may differ from an older description.

IN USE identify the current product

Precision check

A plain-looking bun is not an ingredient list. Ingredient information and cross-contact information answer related but different questions. Removing visible seeds does not establish suitability. An old menu description cannot certify the actual product being prepared today.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

recipe change

Alteration to a dish's ingredients or method.

IN USE verify a recipe change

product substitution

Use of a different supplied item in place of the usual one.

IN USE check for a product substitution

allergy flag

Clear system marker identifying a reported allergy for the relevant order.

IN USE enter an allergy flag

kitchen lead

Responsible kitchen colleague coordinating the relevant preparation question.

IN USE consult the kitchen lead

order hold

Pause before progressing an order while a necessary matter is resolved.

IN USE maintain the order hold

ingredient verification

Check of the ingredients in the actual relevant product.

IN USE complete ingredient verification

handling information

Details about how food is stored, prepared, and served.

IN USE obtain handling information

unsupported assurance

Reassuring claim without adequate information or authority.

IN USE avoid an unsupported assurance

reported allergen

Substance the guest identifies as the source of an allergy.

IN USE repeat the reported allergen

alternative dish

Different menu item that still requires appropriate checks for the guest.

IN USE check an alternative dish

allergic reaction

Response to an allergen that may require urgent medical attention.

IN USE follow allergic-reaction procedures

emergency response

Immediate action through the applicable emergency arrangements.

IN USE activate the emergency response

Precision check

No reaction or exposure occurs in this scenario. Do not invent treatment instructions or tell a guest to test the food. Actual symptoms or urgent concerns require the appropriate emergency response, not completion of a routine menu inquiry.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DISCLOSURE

"Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy."

REPEAT THE ALLERGEN

"I have heard sesame; is that correct?"

STATE THE INFORMATION LIMIT

"This old description does not verify today's bun."

PAUSE THE ORDER

"I will check before sending an order."

NAME THE NEXT PERSON

"I will speak with Cam, our kitchen lead."

ASK ABOUT THE ACTUAL PRODUCT

"Which bun is being used for this service?"

ASK ABOUT THE RECORD

"Can you verify its current ingredient information?"

INCLUDE HANDLING

"We also need the relevant cross-contact information."

Thank you for telling me

Receives the information without questioning the guest's credibility.

Today's bun

Directs the check to the actual product, not an outdated menu.

Before sending

Places verification ahead of order transmission.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID APPEARANCE-BASED REASSURANCE

"A plain surface does not establish the ingredients."

KEEP THE GUEST INFORMED

"The question is still being checked."

PRESERVE THE ALLERGY FLAG

"The reported sesame allergy must stay linked to your order."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED CERTAINTY

"I cannot confirm suitability from the information available."

DO NOT IMPROVISE A FIX

"Removing visible seeds would not answer the safety question."

AVOID A FALSE ALTERNATIVE

"A different dish would need its own appropriate checks."

SEPARATE RECEIPT AND RESOLUTION

"Cam has received the question; it is not resolved yet."

RETURN TO THE GUEST ACCURATELY

"I will explain the verified information and any remaining limits before you choose."

Also

Makes clear that handling is an additional issue, not answered by ingredients alone.

Still being checked

Gives an honest interim status.

Cannot confirm

Marks an information limit without inventing a safe or unsafe verdict.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which first response is best?

- A** Try a small bite first.
- B** Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.
- C** The bun looks plain, so it is safe.
- D** Pick off any visible seeds.

2. Which distinction matters?

- A** Receiving a question automatically resolves it.
- B** Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.
- C** A plain appearance proves no sesame.
- D** An old menu is always current.

3. What does Cam's availability establish?

- A** A kitchen lead can discuss the query.
- B** The bun has been certified suitable.
- C** No allergy flag is needed.
- D** A different dish is automatically safe.

4. Which guest update is accurate?

- A** Every dish is safe for every allergy.
- B** The old description is enough.
- C** A reaction has occurred even though none is reported.
- D** I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Checking the bun before ordering

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

order hold / product specification / ingredient verification / cross-contact / reported allergen / allergy flag / ingredient list / handling information / alternative dish / current product

- 01 **Eli:** Before I order, I need to ask about the burger bun. I have a sesame allergy, and the picture does not tell me what is in the bread.
- 02 **Noor:** Thank you for telling me. I will repeat the ¹ _____ when I speak with the kitchen: sesame. Is that correct, and is the bun the item you want me to check?
- 03 **Eli:** Yes, sesame, and I am asking about the bun first. I know some bread can contain it even without seeds on the surface.
- 04 **Noor:** I have only an old description here, not verified information for the ² _____. I will check with Cam, our kitchen lead, before sending an order.
- 05 **Eli:** Please include how it is handled, not just the ingredients. I would rather wait for an accurate answer than have someone tell me it is probably fine.
- 06 **Noor:** Of course. I will ask about the ingredients and ³ _____. I cannot confirm suitability from this description, and I will not put the order through while that question is unresolved.
- 07 **Eli:** Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information.
- 08 **Noor:** Yes, Cam has received it. We need the current ⁴ _____ for today's bun. That check has not been completed, so the old description is not our answer.
- 09 **Eli:** And the preparation question is with Cam too? I would not want a confirmed list to be presented as confirmation of everything else.
- 10 **Noor:** Yes. The relevant ⁵ _____ still needs verification through our allergy procedure. I made clear that you are asking about both ingredients and preparation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Eli:** Thank you. I also do not want anyone to remove visible seeds and assume that has answered the question. The bread itself matters.
- 12 **Noor:** Agreed. We need the actual ⁶ _____ and relevant supplier information. A plain surface or removal of visible seeds is not enough to establish suitability.
- 13 **Eli:** Please do not prepare a different dish while you check, either. I have not chosen an alternative or asked for a substitution.
- 14 **Noor:** Understood. The ⁷ _____ remains in place. Any alternative would need its own appropriate checks and your agreement before we proceed.
- 15 **Eli:** When you return, could you make clear which information has actually been checked? I need to distinguish a progress update from a confirmed result.
- 16 **Noor:** Certainly. The ⁸ _____ and preparation checks are not complete yet. I will keep their actual status clear rather than describe Cam receiving the question as a final answer.
- 17 **Eli:** Thank you for being clear. Please do not enter a substitute on my behalf while you are checking. I have not chosen something else.
- 18 **Noor:** I will not. Any ⁹ _____ would need its own checks and your choice. Your order has not been sent.
- 19 **Eli:** That is fine. I will wait for the verified information before deciding. Please keep the sesame allergy attached to the discussion if someone else takes over.
- 20 **Noor:** Yes. The ¹⁰ _____ and the unresolved question must stay together. I will return with the information we can actually confirm and explain any remaining limits.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. reported allergen | 2. current product | 3. cross-contact | 4. ingredient list | 5. handling information | 6. product specification | 7. order hold | 8. ingredient verification | 9. alternative dish | 10. allergy flag

Receive a different allergen question

F Say it

03

At table 9, guest Alex reports a peanut allergy and asks about a sauce. The server has an old description only. Kitchen lead Imani accepts the query. No ingredient or handling answer is yet verified.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Imani / peanut / sauce / confirmed

Server: "The reported allergen is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The product being questioned is the ² _____."

Server: "The receiving kitchen lead is ³ _____."

Colleague: "Suitability is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. peanut | 2. sauce | 3. Imani | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eight more minutes?

A Read the situation

04

Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

Table 14 has finished its starters. The mains were fired at 7:20. At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes because one dish is still being prepared. The guests need to leave at 7:50. Server Tomas must explain the current estimate and offer a discussion about timing, while avoiding a promise that the mains will arrive exactly at 7:38 or that the guests can finish comfortably before departure. No cancellation, faster substitute, priority slot, or price adjustment has been approved in this case.

PEOPLE / Tomas: Server | Riley: Guest at table 14

TELL THE GUEST WHAT THE CLOCK ACTUALLY MEANS

Internal timing can sound like a promise when repeated without context. Translate preparation status into guest-facing language, acknowledge the departure constraint, and check realistic options. Do not hide uncertainty behind kitchen jargon or assume the guest has enough time to eat.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. When were the mains fired?

A 7:30

B 7:38 as a completed event

C 7:50

D 7:20

2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?

A Guaranteed departure at 7:38

B Another eight minutes

C Eight minutes total since 7:20

D Guaranteed service at 7:30

3. What is the guests' departure requirement?

A Arrive at 7:50

B Finish paying yesterday

C Leave at 7:50

D Begin starters at 7:50

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fire

Kitchen instruction to begin or advance preparation at the required service stage.

IN USE fire the mains

fired time

Recorded time when the relevant preparation instruction was given.

IN USE confirm the fired time

pickup

Kitchen-to-service handoff when dishes are ready for collection.

IN USE coordinate pickup

pass

Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff.

IN USE collect from the pass

expeditor

Person coordinating dish completion and kitchen-to-floor delivery.

IN USE check with the expeditor

course pacing

Timing of successive stages of a meal.

IN USE adjust course pacing

ticket time

Elapsed time associated with an order ticket, measured from a specified event.

IN USE check the ticket time

readiness estimate

Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage.

IN USE give a readiness estimate

remaining time

Additional duration expected from the current update.

IN USE state the remaining time

departure deadline

Latest time by which guests need to leave.

IN USE acknowledge the departure deadline

service window

Period available for serving or completing a specified service activity.

IN USE discuss the service window

preparation stage

Current step in making a dish.

IN USE confirm the preparation stage

Precision check

Eight more minutes at 7:30 points to approximately 7:38 for the stated readiness estimate. It is not eight minutes from 7:20. Readiness, delivery to the table, eating, payment, and departure are separate events.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

table update

Information given to guests about their order or service.

IN USE deliver a table update

timing constraint

Limit that affects when something needs to occur.

IN USE clarify the timing constraint

bottleneck

Step limiting the progress of the overall process.

IN USE identify the bottleneck

coordinated service

Arrangement for related dishes to reach guests in a planned sequence.

IN USE arrange coordinated service

rush request

Request to accelerate work that still requires confirmation.

IN USE check a rush request

priority

Relative precedence given to a task under the actual service arrangement.

IN USE confirm priority

on the fly

Urgent preparation request in restaurant shorthand, not a guarantee of instant service.

IN USE request a dish on the fly

elapsed time

Duration already passed between specified points.

IN USE calculate elapsed time

update point

Agreed occasion for communicating the next status.

IN USE agree an update point

timing discussion

Conversation about feasible options under a time constraint.

IN USE offer a timing discussion

completion promise

Commitment that a stated outcome will occur by a defined time.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion promise

contingency

Alternative arrangement available if the intended plan cannot work.

IN USE verify a contingency

Precision check

The twelve minutes between 7:38 and 7:50 is a clock difference, not proof of a comfortable meal. Confirm what the kitchen estimate covers and discuss actual options. Do not promise an accelerated dish or cancellation before the appropriate decision is made.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE WAIT

"I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected."

NAME THE REMAINING WORK

"One dish is still being prepared."

PRESERVE THE SOURCE

"This is the kitchen's current estimate."

AVOID A FALSE COMFORT CLAIM

"I cannot promise that leaves enough time for your meal."

GIVE THE CURRENT UPDATE

"At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes."

TRANSLATE THE ESTIMATE

"That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time."

REPEAT THE CONSTRAINT

"You need to leave at 7:50."

SEPARATE STAGES

"Kitchen readiness and arrival at the table are different stages."

Another

Marks additional time from the current update.

Around

Signals approximation rather than a fixed appointment.

Current estimate

Allows for a changed status without pretending certainty.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

OFFER A DISCUSSION

"Let me discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen."

CLARIFY THE CLOCK

"The eight minutes is from the 7:30 update."

DO NOT PROMISE A SUBSTITUTE

"Any alternative timing needs to be checked."

DO NOT DISMISS THE DEADLINE

"Your departure time matters to the decision."

AVOID INVENTED PRIORITY

"I cannot promise a faster slot before it is confirmed."

KEEP THE EARLIER TIME CLEAR

"The mains were fired at 7:20."

AGREE THE NEXT COMMUNICATION

"Let us agree when you will receive the next update."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The estimate is still provisional, and the timing options need discussion."

Need to leave

Identifies a departure constraint, not a food-readiness target.

Before it is confirmed

Keeps a request distinct from an accepted commitment.

Enough time

Requires the guest's practical needs, not arithmetic alone.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which timing explanation is accurate?

- A** The guests can definitely finish by 7:50.
- B** At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.
- C** The mains were served at 7:20.
- D** Eight minutes from 7:20 guarantees service at 7:28.

2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?

- A** A promise that payment is complete
- B** A confirmed twelve-minute cooking time
- C** That the guests can stay indefinitely
- D** A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time

3. Which offer stays within the facts?

- A** I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.
- B** I guarantee a replacement in two minutes.
- C** The bill is already canceled.
- D** Your table has automatically received top priority.

4. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?

- A** The current estimate is eight more minutes.
- B** Your mains were fired at 7:20.
- C** You need to leave at 7:50.
- D** One dish is still being prepared.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Eight more minutes?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

rush request / table update / completion promise / timing discussion / readiness estimate / departure deadline / fired time / Pickup / remaining time / timing constraint

- 01 **Riley:** Could you check our mains, please? We have finished the starters, and we need to leave at seven fifty. I am beginning to worry about the time.
- 02 **Tomas:** I am sorry about the wait. I have a current ¹ _____ from the kitchen: at seven thirty, they expect another eight minutes. One dish is still being prepared.
- 03 **Riley:** Eight minutes from when? We ordered earlier, so I want to make sure that does not mean eight minutes from the start of cooking.
- 04 **Tomas:** The ² _____ is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.
- 05 **Riley:** When did the kitchen start the mains? I am not asking you to blame anyone; I am trying to understand how far along they are.
- 06 **Tomas:** The ³ _____ was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.
- 07 **Riley:** All right. If they are ready around seven thirty-eight, that leaves twelve minutes before we have to go. That sounds rather tight for us.
- 08 **Tomas:** I agree that your ⁴ _____ matters. The twelve minutes is only the difference between those times; it does not guarantee enough time to receive the food, eat, and settle the bill.
- 09 **Riley:** Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to.
- 10 **Tomas:** I can discuss a ⁵ _____ with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Riley:** Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available.
- 12 **Tomas:** We can have a ⁶ _____ about that. I would need the kitchen to check any alternative; I do not have a confirmed substitute time to offer you now.
- 13 **Riley:** Please do that. I would rather hear a realistic limitation than be told everything is fine and discover too late that we need to leave.
- 14 **Tomas:** Understood. My next ⁷ _____ should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.
- 15 **Riley:** Yes. And please do not treat seven thirty-eight as the time we will definitely be eating. There could still be a gap before the plates reach us.
- 16 **Tomas:** Correct. ⁸ _____ and delivery to the table are separate from the cooking estimate. I will clarify which stage the estimate covers when I speak with the kitchen.
- 17 **Riley:** Thank you. We still need to leave at seven fifty, even if the food is delayed. That is the constraint we need you to work with.
- 18 **Tomas:** I will carry that ⁹ _____ into the conversation. I will not represent your departure as flexible or assume you can stay longer.
- 19 **Riley:** Then please check the options, and come back with the actual answer. We have not agreed to a substitute or canceled anything yet.
- 20 **Tomas:** Agreed. I will avoid a ¹⁰ _____ I cannot support. Your order status, the current estimate, and any decision we make next will stay clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. readiness estimate | 2. remaining time | 3. fixed time | 4. departure deadline | 5. rush request | 6. timing discussion | 7. table update | 8. Pickup | 9. timing constraint | 10. completion promise

Anchor a new estimate

F Say it

At 8:10, the kitchen estimates six more minutes for a dish. The guests need to leave at 8:30. No faster alternative or guaranteed table-delivery time has been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

8:30 / 8:16 / 8:10 / unconfirmed

Server: "The estimate starts from ¹ _____."

Guest: "That points to around ² _____."

Server: "Your departure requirement is ³ _____."

Guest: "A faster alternative remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 8:10 | 2. 8:16 | 3. 8:30 | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

A Read the situation

Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

05

At table 3, guest Alex ordered vegetable pasta but received mushroom risotto. The ticket confirms vegetable pasta. Server Dana checks the mismatch and learns that the kitchen can remake the pasta with an estimated ten-minute wait. Dana may offer that replacement, but any bill adjustment requires shift lead review. The cause of the wrong delivery is not established. No allergy is reported. Alex has not accepted the remake at the start, and neither compensation nor a guaranteed ten-minute arrival has been approved.

PEOPLE / Alex: Guest at table 3 | Dana: Server

AN APOLOGY CAN BE DIRECT

Name the mismatch without making the guest prove an error already confirmed by the ticket. Take responsibility for the next step without guessing which colleague caused the problem. A sincere apology does not require inventing a free meal or a guaranteed preparation time.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the ticket confirm?

A A canceled order

C Mushroom risotto

B Vegetable pasta

D Two identical risottos

2. What replacement can Dana offer?

A A completed refund

C A guaranteed two-minute steak

B A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

D An automatic free meal

3. Who must review a bill adjustment?

A An unnamed supplier

C Any guest at a nearby table

B The shift lead

D Dana automatically without review

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

order mismatch

Difference between what was ordered and what was delivered or recorded.

IN USE acknowledge the order mismatch

remake

Newly prepared replacement for a dish that needs correction.

IN USE request a remake

replacement offer

Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept.

IN USE explain the replacement offer

service recovery

Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest.

IN USE manage service recovery

apology

Direct expression of regret for an error or inconvenience.

IN USE offer a clear apology

inconvenience

Practical difficulty or disruption caused to the guest.

IN USE acknowledge the inconvenience

ticket check

Review of the order record to establish what was entered.

IN USE perform a ticket check

delivered dish

Food actually brought to the guest.

IN USE identify the delivered dish

ordered dish

Food the guest requested.

IN USE confirm the ordered dish

confirmed mismatch

Discrepancy established by the available record and observation.

IN USE state the confirmed mismatch

cause

Reason an error occurred, which may require further investigation.

IN USE avoid guessing the cause

blame

Attribution of fault to a person or group.

IN USE avoid unsupported blame

Precision check

The ticket confirms pasta, so the server can acknowledge the mismatch without guessing its cause. The kitchen offers a remake; the guest still needs to accept it. An available remedy is not the same as a completed resolution.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

remedy

Action intended to put a problem right.

IN USE offer an available remedy

estimated wait

Approximate expected delay before a specified next event.

IN USE explain the estimated wait

acceptance

Agreement to a proposed option.

IN USE confirm acceptance

bill adjustment

Authorized change to an amount on the guest's bill.

IN USE request a bill adjustment

comp

Informal restaurant term for an item provided without charge under authorization.

IN USE obtain approval for a comp

discount

Reduction from a stated price.

IN USE authorize a discount

refund

Return of money already paid.

IN USE process an approved refund

void

Cancellation of a transaction or entry through the relevant system procedure.

IN USE record an authorized void

shift lead

Person coordinating service decisions during a shift.

IN USE consult the shift lead

approval limit

Boundary on the decisions someone may authorize.

IN USE observe an approval limit

resolution status

Whether the proposed correction has actually been agreed and completed.

IN USE confirm the resolution status

follow-up check

Later confirmation that the corrective action occurred and met the stated need.

IN USE make a follow-up check

Precision check

A remake, comp, discount, void, and refund are different actions. A refund returns paid money; a bill adjustment may happen before payment. Follow actual approval and payment procedures, and do not describe shift-lead review as a completed financial decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE MISMATCH

"You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto."

REFER TO THE RECORD

"I checked the ticket, and it confirms the pasta."

OFFER THE ACTUAL REMEDY

"The kitchen can remake the vegetable pasta."

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"Would you like that replacement?"

APOLOGIZE DIRECTLY

"I am sorry; that is not the dish you ordered."

AVOID BLAMING THE GUEST

"You do not need to explain the order again."

STATE THE ESTIMATED WAIT

"The current estimate is ten minutes."

KEEP TIMING HONEST

"I cannot guarantee an exact arrival time."

We brought

Acknowledges the service error without assigning unsupported individual blame.

Confirms

Identifies evidence for what was ordered.

Can remake

Describes an available action, not one already completed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID GUESSING FAULT

"I have not established how the mismatch happened."

SEPARATE THE FINANCIAL QUESTION

"Any bill adjustment needs the shift lead's review."

NAME THE NEXT ACTION

"I will bring the bill question to the shift lead."

CHECK COMPLETION LATER

"I will confirm that the correct dish reaches you."

ADDRESS THE PRACTICAL EFFECT

"I understand that the extra wait affects your meal."

DO NOT PROMISE AN UNAUTHORIZED COMP

"I cannot confirm a free item before approval."

KEEP CONSENT CLEAR

"We have offered the remake, but you have not accepted it yet."

CLOSE WITH THE TWO TRACKS

"We need to confirm your replacement choice and review the bill question separately."

Would you like

Requests the guest's decision.

Current estimate

Preserves uncertainty in preparation timing.

Needs review

Marks a pending decision rather than approval.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which apology fits the facts?

- A** I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.
- B** You must have ordered incorrectly.
- C** The cook deliberately ignored you.
- D** Nothing went wrong because both dishes contain vegetables.

2. Which offer is authorized?

- A** A guaranteed ten-minute arrival and free meal
- B** A refund already completed
- C** Any replacement at any price with no check
- D** A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

3. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?

- A** I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.
- B** I have already approved a comp.
- C** Every remake legally requires a refund.
- D** The kitchen estimate authorizes a discount.

4. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?

- A** Before the guest accepts an offer
- B** As soon as someone guesses the cause
- C** After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked
- D** Immediately when an apology is spoken

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

resolution status / bill adjustment / shift lead / cause / acceptance / estimated wait / comp / order mismatch / remake / follow-up check

- 01 **Alex:** Excuse me, this is mushroom risotto. I ordered the vegetable pasta. Could you check the order, please? I do not think this is my main.
- 02 **Dana:** I am sorry about the ¹ _____. I checked the ticket, and it confirms vegetable pasta. We brought the wrong dish.
- 03 **Alex:** Thank you for checking. I was worried I would have to explain the whole order again. What can you do to put it right?
- 04 **Dana:** The kitchen can offer a ² _____ of the vegetable pasta. The current estimate is ten minutes. Would you like that replacement, or do you need to discuss the options first?
- 05 **Alex:** Ten minutes would change the timing of our meal. Is that a firm promise that the plate will be here exactly ten minutes from now?
- 06 **Dana:** It is an ³ _____, not a guaranteed arrival time. I understand that waiting again affects your meal, and I do not want to promise a time I cannot confirm.
- 07 **Alex:** I appreciate that. I am also concerned about paying the same bill after receiving the wrong dish and having to wait again.
- 08 **Dana:** I can take that ⁴ _____ question to the shift lead. I may offer the remake, but I cannot approve a financial change myself in this situation.
- 09 **Alex:** So you are not telling me the pasta will automatically be free? I would rather know that now than have a different conversation when the check arrives.
- 10 **Dana:** Correct. A ⁵ _____ has not been approved. I will explain the mismatch and the extra wait to the shift lead and ask for a decision.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Alex:** Do you know why it happened? The ticket was right, but the dish was wrong. Was it sent from the kitchen that way?
- 12 **Dana:** I have not established the ⁶ _____. I can confirm the mismatch, but I should not blame a colleague or guess at the sequence before it has been checked.
- 13 **Alex:** If I agree to the remake, will you make sure the correct dish reaches this table? I do not want the same confusion again.
- 14 **Dana:** Yes, I will make a ⁷ _____ on the corrected order and its delivery. I will also keep you informed if the timing changes rather than let the estimate silently pass.
- 15 **Alex:** Please ask the shift lead about the bill first. I have heard the remake offer, but I have not accepted it yet.
- 16 **Dana:** I understand. Your ⁸ _____ is still pending. I will not describe the replacement as agreed or the meal problem as resolved before you have chosen.
- 17 **Alex:** Thank you. Please make sure the person reviewing the bill knows both what I ordered and what actually arrived, along with the extra waiting time.
- 18 **Dana:** I will give the ⁹ _____ those facts: pasta ordered and confirmed on the ticket, risotto delivered, remake offered at an estimated ten minutes.
- 19 **Alex:** That is accurate. I would like the next update to tell me what has actually been approved and what choice you still need from me.
- 20 **Dana:** Certainly. I will keep the ¹⁰ _____ clear. The remake awaits your decision, and any bill adjustment awaits the shift lead's review.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. order mismatch | 2. remake | 3. estimated wait | 4. bill adjustment | 5. comp | 6. cause | 7. follow-up check | 8. acceptance | 9. shift lead | 10. resolution status

Offer a different correction

F Say it

Table 7 ordered lentil soup but received tomato soup. The ticket confirms lentil soup. A remake is available with an estimated seven-minute wait. Lead Noor must review any bill adjustment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

lentil / Noor / seven / tomato

Server: "The ticket confirms ¹ _____ soup."

Guest: "The delivered soup was ² _____."

Server: "The estimated remake wait is ³ _____ minutes."

Guest: "The bill question goes to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. lentil | 2. tomato | 3. seven | 4. Noor

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

What does three ways mean?

A Read the situation

Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

Three diners have a fictional \$72 bill, with all listed charges included. Guest Morgan asks to split it "three ways." The restaurant can arrange equal payments or separate checks by item before payment is processed. Server Jules must ask which method the diners mean. Equal shares would be \$24 each; item-based shares cannot be calculated without the item allocation. No additional charge, tip decision, completed payment, or refund is supplied. Morgan later confirms that the group wants three equal payments, and Jules reads back that choice before processing.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Guest speaking for the group | Jules: Server

DO NOT MAKE THE SOCIAL DECISION FOR THE TABLE

Guests may use split loosely, while differing about who should pay for shared dishes. Clarify the method without judging fairness or announcing private assumptions about relationships. Keep the conversation practical and confirm amounts before a payment is submitted.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the stated bill total?

- A \$72 with all listed charges included
- C \$24 for the entire table

- B \$72 plus an invented charge
- D An unknown total

2. What does three ways need to clarify?

- A Equal payments or separate checks by item
- C Whether the meal happened yesterday

- B Whether there are three diners at all
- D Whether every diner ordered identical food

3. What is each equal share?

- A \$36
- C \$27

- B \$18
- D \$24

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

check

Restaurant bill listing the guest's charges.

IN USE bring the check

bill total

Amount due for the listed charges.

IN USE confirm the bill total

itemized bill

Bill showing individual items or charges.

IN USE review the itemized bill

split payment

Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers.

IN USE arrange a split payment

equal share

Same portion of the total assigned to each person.

IN USE calculate an equal share

separate check

Individual bill assigned to a particular diner or group.

IN USE prepare separate checks

item allocation

Assignment of particular ordered items to particular payers.

IN USE confirm the item allocation

shared item

Dish or charge used by more than one diner.

IN USE allocate a shared item

allocation method

Agreed way of dividing the total or items.

IN USE clarify the allocation method

subtotal

Sum before the specified additional components included in a final total.

IN USE distinguish the subtotal

listed charge

Amount explicitly shown on the bill.

IN USE verify a listed charge

service charge

Charge imposed under the restaurant's stated terms, distinct from a discretionary tip.

IN USE explain a service charge

06

Precision check

Three equal shares of \$72 are \$24 each. That arithmetic does not show what each diner consumed. Separate checks by item need an agreed allocation, including shared items, before amounts can be determined.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

gratuity

Tip, whose treatment depends on the actual payment context and applicable rules.

IN USE clarify a gratuity

payment method

Means used to pay, such as a card or cash.

IN USE confirm the payment method

card terminal

Device used to submit a card payment.

IN USE present the card terminal

authorization

Approval stage for a payment under the relevant payment system.

IN USE check payment authorization

payment receipt

Record acknowledging the payment transaction.

IN USE provide a payment receipt

outstanding balance

Amount that remains unpaid.

IN USE confirm the outstanding balance

partial payment

Payment of less than the full amount due.

IN USE record a partial payment

payment confirmation

Evidence or acknowledgment that a payment was completed at the relevant stage.

IN USE check payment confirmation

rounding

Adjustment to an available monetary precision under the relevant method.

IN USE explain rounding

duplicate charge

Repeated charge for the same item or transaction where duplication is at issue.

IN USE investigate a duplicate charge

reconciliation

Comparison of payments and amounts due to check that records agree.

IN USE complete payment reconciliation

settle the bill

Complete payment of the amount due.

IN USE settle the bill

06

Precision check

The scenario supplies a total with all listed charges included; do not add a guessed fee or assume a tip decision. Confirm actual restaurant terms and the guest-selected payment amounts. Agreeing a split is not proof that money has been collected.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE REQUEST

"Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?"

EXPLAIN EQUAL SHARES

"Three equal shares would be \$24 each."

HANDLE SHARED DISHES

"How should the shared items be allocated?"

CHECK THE TIMING

"We can arrange either method before processing payment."

STATE THE TOTAL

"The bill total is \$72."

EXPLAIN THE OTHER METHOD

"For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person."

AVOID A FAIRNESS ASSUMPTION

"I will use the method your group agrees on."

CONFIRM THE SELECTED METHOD

"You would like three equal payments, correct?"

06

Do you mean

Offers two concrete interpretations instead of making a guess.

Would be

Gives the amount conditional on choosing equal shares.

By item

Refers to consumption allocation rather than equal portions of the total.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

READ BACK THE AMOUNT

"That is \$24 for each of the three payments."

SEPARATE THE TIP DECISION

"No tip choice has been specified in this exchange."

CHECK THE TERMINAL AMOUNT

"Please check the amount before confirming the payment."

OFFER A RECEIPT

"I can provide the relevant payment receipt through our process."

DO NOT INVENT AN EXTRA CHARGE

"The stated total already includes all listed charges."

KEEP PAYMENT STATUS FACTUAL

"The split is agreed, but no payment has been processed yet."

TRACK WHAT REMAINS

"We need to record each actual payment against the balance."

CLOSE BEFORE PROCESSING

"Three equal payments of \$24, against the \$72 total."

06

Before processing

Locates the clarification before a transaction occurs.

Each

Makes clear that twenty-four dollars applies to every equal share.

Agreed, but not processed

Separates a payment plan from completed payment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?

- A** Three ways always means three unequal checks, right?
- B** Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?
- C** You all ate exactly the same amount, correct?
- D** Shall I charge the loudest guest everything?

2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?

- A** \$72 divided by 3 is \$36 each.
- B** Three payments of \$24 leave \$24 unpaid.
- C** Three payments of \$72 equal the original bill.
- D** \$72 divided by 3 is \$24 each.

3. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?

- A** An agreed allocation of items and shared charges
- B** Only the number of diners
- C** A guessed tip amount
- D** An assumption that all dishes cost the same

4. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?

- A** That every card has been charged
- B** That a refund was issued
- C** That all fees may be added again
- D** The intended allocation, not completed payment

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

What does three ways mean?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

payment confirmation / bill total / outstanding balance / listed charge / item allocation / card terminal / allocation method / equal shares / payment receipt / split payment

06

- 01 **Morgan:** Could we split this three ways, please? There are three of us, and we would like to sort it out before everyone starts reaching for a card.
- 02 **Jules:** Certainly. Do you mean three ¹ _____, or would you like separate checks according to what each person ordered? We can arrange either before payment.
- 03 **Morgan:** I had not realized the phrase could mean two things. What would the equal option be for the bill we have in front of us?
- 04 **Jules:** The ² _____ is seventy-two dollars. Divided equally among three people, that is twenty-four dollars each. Those three amounts add back to seventy-two.
- 05 **Morgan:** And if we pay for our own dishes instead, you would need us to tell you which items belong to which person, is that right?
- 06 **Jules:** Yes. That requires an ³ _____. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.
- 07 **Morgan:** We did share some food, so equal payments may be simpler for us. Let me confirm with the others before you enter anything.
- 08 **Jules:** Of course. The ⁴ _____ should be your group's choice. I will wait rather than treat our discussion as permission to process a payment.
- 09 **Morgan:** They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us.
- 10 **Jules:** Thank you. I will arrange the ⁵ _____ as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Morgan:** Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars.
- 12 **Jules:** We will check each amount on the ⁶ _____ before it is confirmed. Agreeing twenty-four each does not mean a payment has already been taken.
- 13 **Morgan:** The bill already shows its listed charges. We are not asking you to add those again when you divide it among the three of us.
- 14 **Jules:** Correct. The ⁷ _____ amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.
- 15 **Morgan:** Thank you. Can each person receive a record of the payment they actually make? That would help us keep our own records afterward.
- 16 **Jules:** We can provide the relevant ⁸ _____ through our payment process. It needs to reflect the payment that is actually completed, not just the split we have agreed.
- 17 **Morgan:** And while the payments are going through, you will track what has been paid so the last person is not charged the full bill again?
- 18 **Jules:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.
- 19 **Morgan:** Good. Then the arrangement is settled, but the payment itself is still to happen. We are ready for you to begin with the agreed amounts.
- 20 **Jules:** Exactly. We will obtain ¹⁰ _____ through the actual process. Three equal payments of twenty-four dollars is the instruction I am working from.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. equal shares | 2. bill total | 3. item allocation | 4. allocation method | 5. split payment | 6. card terminal | 7. listed charge | 8. payment receipt | 9. outstanding balance | 10. payment confirmation

Clarify four ways

F Say it

Four diners have a \$96 total with all listed charges included. The restaurant supports equal payments or item-based checks before payment. The diners confirm equal payments. No payment has been processed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

equal / ninety-six / twenty-four / processed

Server: "You have chosen ¹ _____ payments."

Guest: "Each share is ² _____ dollars."

Server: "The full total remains ³ _____ dollars."

Guest: "The payments are not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. equal | 2. twenty-four | 3. ninety-six | 4. processed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An empty plate still in use

A Read the situation

Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

At table 2, one diner has an empty plate, but the shared vegetable dish still contains food. The diner is using that plate for another portion. Server Mina and food runner Leo need to coordinate clearing. Extra sharing plates can be offered, but active items should remain unless the guest agrees otherwise. No request to end the meal or prepare the table for new guests has been made. The colleagues discuss the words Leo can use, then agree that he will ask what can be cleared rather than silently remove the plate.

PEOPLE / Mina: Server responsible for table 2 | Leo: Food runner helping with clearing

07

ASK RATHER THAN APPLY A DINING STEREOTYPE

Dining customs differ, but nationality is not a reliable instruction for a particular table. An empty plate, a pause, or a cutlery position can be ambiguous. Ask a short question about the actual item and respect the answer without making guests explain their culture.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why is the empty plate still needed?

- A** The table is being reset for new guests.
- B** The plate is abandoned as an established fact.
- C** The diner is using it for another portion.
- D** The meal has definitely ended.

2. What remains in the shared dish?

- A** Nothing at all
- B** Vegetables
- C** Only an empty serving vessel
- D** A confirmed discarded meal

3. What may the team offer?

- A** A bill adjustment already approved
- B** Extra sharing plates
- C** Unrequested removal of all active dishes
- D** A new reservation without asking

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

clear

Remove dining items that are ready to be taken away.

IN USE ask before clearing

pre-bus

Remove agreed finished items during a meal before the table's final clearing.

IN USE pre-bus discreetly

busser

Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks.

IN USE coordinate with the busser

food runner

Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service.

IN USE brief the food runner

sharing plate

Plate provided for taking a portion from a shared dish.

IN USE offer a sharing plate

shared dish

Food presented for more than one person to serve from.

IN USE leave the shared dish

serving utensil

Tool used to transfer food from a serving dish to a plate.

IN USE provide a serving utensil

place setting

Arrangement of dining items for one person.

IN USE maintain the place setting

side plate

Small plate used for bread, sides, or another specified purpose.

IN USE offer a side plate

sideboard

Service furniture or station used to hold dining-room supplies.

IN USE restock the sideboard

service station

Area holding supplies and equipment for dining-room work.

IN USE organize the service station

cutlery

Knives, forks, and spoons used for eating.

IN USE replace the cutlery

Precision check

Empty describes the plate contents at one moment. Finished describes the guest no longer needing it. The two are not equivalent here. A shared dish with food and an empty individual plate can belong to the same continuing meal.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

flatware

Common US term for eating utensils such as knives, forks, and spoons.

IN USE provide clean flatware

crockery

Plates, bowls, and other ceramic dining vessels.

IN USE handle the crockery

glassware

Drinking vessels made of glass.

IN USE collect finished glassware

active item

Item still being used or needed by a guest.

IN USE leave active items

finished item

Item the guest has finished using and agrees can be removed.

IN USE identify finished items

clearing permission

Guest agreement to remove a particular item.

IN USE obtain clearing permission

service cue

Action or signal that may suggest a service need but can require clarification.

IN USE clarify a service cue

meal pace

Speed and rhythm at which guests are eating.

IN USE respect the meal pace

table reset

Preparation of a cleared table for its next guests.

IN USE begin an authorized table reset

table turnover

Transition from one party's use of a table to the next.

IN USE manage table turnover

unobtrusive service

Assistance that meets guest needs without unnecessary interruption.

IN USE provide unobtrusive service

guest preference

Individual request about how service should be provided.

IN USE confirm the guest preference

Precision check

May I clear this plate? asks about a particular item. Are you finished with everything? is broader and can create pressure or misunderstanding. Identify the item, wait for the answer, and keep the agreed clearing action aligned across the team.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT AN ITEM

"May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?"

CHECK THE SHARED DISH

"Would you like the vegetables to stay on the table?"

AVOID AN ASSUMPTION

"An empty plate does not necessarily mean the guest has finished."

STATE THE OBSERVED FACT

"The shared dish still has food in it."

ACCEPT CONTINUED USE

"Of course; I will leave it for your next portion."

OFFER PRACTICAL HELP

"Would extra sharing plates be useful?"

COORDINATE THE TEAM

"Please leave that plate; it is still in use."

KEEP THE QUESTION NARROW

"Ask about the specific item rather than the whole meal."

This plate

Makes the permission request specific.

Or are you still using it

Gives a comfortable way to decline clearing.

Of course

Accepts the preference without making it an inconvenience.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

WAIT FOR PERMISSION

"Let the guest answer before reaching for the plate."

AVOID CULTURAL GUESSES

"We should ask this table what they prefer."

PRESERVE THE SHARED ARRANGEMENT

"Leave the serving dish and active plates in place."

PASS ON THE PREFERENCE

"The diner is keeping the plate for another portion."

RESPECT A REFUSAL

"Certainly; I will leave it where it is."

SEPARATE STAGES

"Clearing one finished item is not a table reset."

KEEP EXTRA ITEMS OPTIONAL

"We can offer more plates without adding them automatically."

CLOSE THE SERVICE LOOP

"Confirm what may be cleared and tell the colleague helping you."

Still

Signals continued use despite the empty surface.

Would be useful

Offers help instead of imposing equipment.

Not necessarily

Challenges an assumption without saying the cue is never meaningful.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question is most appropriate?

- A** You are obviously finished, so I will take everything.
- B** Why are you keeping an empty plate?
- C** Shall I reset the table while you are eating?
- D** May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

2. What does the empty plate establish?

- A** A request for the bill
- B** Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed
- C** Permission to remove every dish
- D** The diner's nationality

3. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?

- A** Treat the meal as complete.
- B** Add an unrequested charge for extra plates.
- C** Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.
- D** Remove the vegetables because one plate is empty.

4. How should cultural differences be handled?

- A** Infer the answer from nationality.
- B** Use one cutlery position as universal proof.
- C** Require guests to explain their cultural background.
- D** Ask the individual table about its preference.

[Answers and explanations: page 88.](#)

An empty plate still in use

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sharing plate / table reset / meal pace / clearing permission / service cue / guest preference / finished item / shared dish / active item / Unobtrusive service

07

- 01 **Leo:** Mina, one plate at table two is empty. I was about to take it away, but the vegetable dish in the middle still has food.
- 02 **Mina:** Please leave that ¹ _____ for now. The diner is using the plate for another portion, so empty does not mean finished in this situation.
- 03 **Leo:** Thank you for catching that. I was reading the empty plate as a signal to clear, and I did not connect it with the food they were sharing.
- 04 **Mina:** A ² _____ can help us notice a need, but it is not always permission. We should check the actual item before reaching across the table.
- 05 **Leo:** What would you say without interrupting the conversation too much? I want the question to be clear but not sound as though I am trying to hurry them.
- 06 **Mina:** Ask for ³ _____ briefly: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then pause long enough for an answer.
- 07 **Leo:** If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it.
- 08 **Mina:** Exactly. Respect the ⁴ _____. We should not turn a small service question into a discussion of their dining customs or why they want to keep the plate.
- 09 **Leo:** We can offer extra plates as well, correct? That might make sharing easier, but I should not bring a stack of them without asking.
- 10 **Mina:** Yes, offer a ⁵ _____ or more if useful. Say, Would extra sharing plates help? We have that option available, but it should remain their choice.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Leo:** I will keep the vegetables in place too. There is still food there, and no one has asked us to remove the dish.
- 12 **Mina:** Good. The ⁶ _____ and the individual plate belong to the same ongoing meal. Do not treat them as unrelated clearing decisions.
- 13 **Leo:** If another guest has actually finished with a glass or plate, may I check that item separately? I do not want to leave everything unnecessarily.
- 14 **Mina:** Yes. A ⁷ _____ can be handled separately. Ask specifically, and keep the action narrow enough that we do not accidentally clear something another diner is using.
- 15 **Leo:** That is different from preparing the table for the next guests. We have no request to end this meal or reset the whole table.
- 16 **Mina:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ is another stage. Our immediate task is to support this table's meal, not turn an empty plate into a deadline.
- 17 **Leo:** I will ask the diner, leave the active items, and offer extra sharing plates. Then I will tell you what they want so we stay consistent.
- 18 **Mina:** Thank you. That supports their ⁹ _____. It also prevents a second colleague from returning a moment later and asking to take the same plate.
- 19 **Leo:** I can keep the wording simple and calm. I do not need to explain every internal service step to the guests while they are eating.
- 20 **Mina:** Exactly. ¹⁰ _____ means noticing, asking briefly, and following the answer. Clear what is agreed, leave what is active, and keep the team informed.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. active item | 2. service cue | 3. clearing permission | 4. guest preference | 5. sharing plate | 6. shared dish | 7. finished item | 8. table reset | 9. meal pace | 10. Unobtrusive service

Check a shared dessert plate

F Say it

At table 9, an empty plate is still needed for more shared dessert. The dessert dish contains food. Extra small plates can be offered. No permission to clear the active plate has been given.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

given / needed / dessert / offered

Server: "The empty plate is still ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The shared dish contains ² _____."

Server: "Extra small plates can be ³ _____."

Colleague: "Clearing permission has not been ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. needed | 2. dessert | 3. offered | 4. given

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two tables, two unfinished tasks

A Read the situation

Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

At 8:00, outgoing server Ben hands tables 4 and 5 to Maya. Table 4 has received its mains, but dessert has not been ordered. Table 5 has an open check and a pending query about a possible duplicate coffee charge. The shift lead is reviewing that query; no duplicate has yet been confirmed and no adjustment is approved. Ben needs Maya to accept both follow-ups explicitly. The handover does not establish a dessert order, a settled bill, or a resolved coffee issue. Maya agrees to take responsibility for the next guest-facing steps.

PEOPLE / Ben: Outgoing server | Maya: Incoming server

08

A HANDOVER IS AN ACCEPTED RESPONSIBILITY

A rushed list of table numbers can hide unfinished work. State the meal stage, the open request, and the person handling any decision. Ask the receiving colleague to repeat the important details so that moving between shifts does not make a live guest concern disappear.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is table 4's meal stage?

A Mains not yet ordered

B Meal canceled

C Mains served; dessert not ordered

D Dessert served and paid

2. What is table 5's check status?

A Never created

B Open

C Paid and closed

D Refunded in full

3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?

A The guest as sole approver of every system change

B No one

C The shift lead

D Maya as an already completed decision

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

section

Group of tables assigned to a server or service team.

IN USE take over a section

live table

Table still receiving service or awaiting completion of a task.

IN USE identify live tables

outgoing server

Colleague transferring responsibility at a shift or section change.

IN USE brief the outgoing server

incoming server

Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period.

IN USE confirm the incoming server

handover

Transfer of relevant information and responsibility between colleagues.

IN USE complete the section handover

handover time

Time at which the responsibility transfer is recorded or agreed.

IN USE state the handover time

table status

Current service stage and relevant conditions for a table.

IN USE summarize the table status

mains served

Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests.

IN USE confirm mains served

dessert decision

Guest choice about whether and what dessert to order.

IN USE follow up the dessert decision

open check

Bill that has not been settled and closed in the relevant system.

IN USE monitor the open check

pending query

Question awaiting an answer or decision.

IN USE carry forward a pending query

suspected duplicate

Possible repeated charge that still requires verification.

IN USE review a suspected duplicate

Precision check

Mains served does not imply dessert ordered. Open check does not imply the bill is correct or the disputed item is wrong. A possible duplicate charge must remain a query until the review establishes the result.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

charge review

Examination of whether a billed amount is correct.

IN USE request a charge review

decision owner

Person authorized or responsible for resolving a specified question.

IN USE identify the decision owner

service owner

Person responsible for the guest-facing follow-up.

IN USE name the service owner

accepted follow-up

Next action explicitly taken on by the receiving colleague.

IN USE record an accepted follow-up

read-back confirmation

Repetition demonstrating that the receiving colleague understood the important details.

IN USE obtain read-back confirmation

closed check

Bill marked settled and closed through the actual payment process.

IN USE verify a closed check

status change

Actual transition from one confirmed state to another.

IN USE communicate a status change

exception note

Record highlighting an issue outside routine service flow.

IN USE preserve an exception note

unresolved item

Task or question that has not been completed or answered.

IN USE track the unresolved item

continuity of service

Uninterrupted attention to guest needs across staff changes.

IN USE maintain continuity of service

handover gap

Missing information or ownership during a transfer of responsibility.

IN USE prevent a handover gap

follow-through

Completion of an accepted action and appropriate communication of its result.

IN USE ensure follow-through

Precision check

The shift lead owns the charge decision; Maya can own the guest-facing update and follow-up. Explicit acceptance keeps these roles connected. Do not close the issue merely because the outgoing server has finished a shift.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE TRANSFER

"It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5."

KEEP DESSERT ACCURATE

"Dessert has not been ordered."

STATE TABLE 5'S BALANCE STATUS

"Table 5 has an open check."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The duplication has not been confirmed."

STATE TABLE 4'S STAGE

"Table 4 has its mains."

NAME THE FIRST FOLLOW-UP

"Please check whether table 4 wants dessert."

IDENTIFY THE QUERY

"They have asked about a possible duplicate coffee charge."

NAME THE DECISION OWNER

"The shift lead is reviewing the charge query."

08

Has its mains

Describes delivery, not the next course choice.

Has not been ordered

Prevents a future possibility from becoming a recorded order.

Possible duplicate

Preserves the uncertainty under review.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID FALSE COMPENSATION

"No adjustment has been approved yet."

READ BACK TABLE 4

"I will follow up dessert without treating it as already ordered."

KEEP PAYMENT SEPARATE

"The check remains open until the actual payment process is completed."

AVOID A FALSE CLOSURE

"The issue is not resolved just because the section changes hands."

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"Can you take both follow-ups?"

READ BACK TABLE 5

"I will track the coffee review and update the guests."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"Keep the unresolved query visible in the handover notes."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"Maya has accepted both guest-facing follow-ups; the shift lead retains the charge review."

08

Is reviewing

Marks an active process, not a completed decision.

Can you take

Requests explicit ownership rather than assuming it.

Remains open

Keeps the payment state tied to actual events.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?

- A Mains still need ordering
- B The table has left and paid
- C Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.
- D Dessert already entered for everyone

2. Which coffee description is justified?

- A A completed refund
- B An error already removed from every record
- C A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review
- D A confirmed fraudulent charge

3. Which ownership arrangement is clear?

- A Ben's departure automatically closes the query.
- B Maya announces approval before receiving a decision.
- C Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.
- D Everyone assumes someone else will handle it.

4. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?

- A The actual relevant payment and closure process
- B Merely changing servers
- C Writing possible duplicate in a note
- D Assuming dessert is unnecessary

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Two tables, two unfinished tasks

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

mains served / open check / continuity of service / status change / dessert decision / service owner / read-back confirmation / exception note / suspected duplicate / handover

08

- 01 **Ben:** Maya, it is eight o'clock. I need to hand over tables four and five before I leave the section. Each has a different follow-up still open.
- 02 **Maya:** I am ready for the ¹ _____. Please give me the current stage and unfinished request for each table so I can take them on clearly.
- 03 **Ben:** Table four has received its mains. Dessert has not been ordered, so please check their choice when it is appropriate in the service.
- 04 **Maya:** Understood: ² _____, dessert not ordered. I will not enter desserts on the assumption that your mention of them means the guests have already chosen.
- 05 **Ben:** Correct. There is no dessert selection for me to pass over. The follow-up is to ask, not to chase a dish that has already been sent.
- 06 **Maya:** I will handle the ³ _____ with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?
- 07 **Ben:** Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question.
- 08 **Maya:** So the ⁴ _____ has a live query attached. I should not treat the bill as settled or the coffee line as already corrected.
- 09 **Ben:** Exactly. I have not been given a review result, and no bill adjustment has been approved. The guest needs an accurate update once there is a decision.
- 10 **Maya:** I will preserve the wording ⁵ _____. I will not tell them the charge is definitely wrong simply because a query has been raised.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ben:** Thank you. The shift lead owns the charge review. I need you to keep the guest communication moving, rather than leave the table waiting because I have gone.
- 12 **Maya:** I can be the ⁶ _____ for that follow-up. The shift lead makes the relevant decision; I track it and explain the actual outcome to the guests.
- 13 **Ben:** That is the distinction. Please keep the unresolved question visible in the notes as well, so it does not disappear when the section assignment changes.
- 14 **Maya:** I will retain the ⁷ _____ and the current status. A change of server should not make a pending charge question look like routine payment completed.
- 15 **Ben:** Can you read back both tasks once more? I want to be sure I have not mixed the table numbers while we are moving between them.
- 16 **Maya:** My ⁸ _____ is table four: follow up the dessert choice. Table five: track the shift-lead coffee review and give the guests the actual update.
- 17 **Ben:** Yes. Neither task is finished yet, and table five remains open. We should not record an adjustment or a payment event before it happens.
- 18 **Maya:** Agreed. Any ⁹ _____ will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.
- 19 **Ben:** Good. You have both follow-ups, and the shift lead still has the charge decision. That gives each next step a clear person to contact.
- 20 **Maya:** Yes, I accept both. I will maintain ¹⁰ _____ for the two tables, check the pending decision, and keep the records aligned with what the guests are actually told.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. handover | 2. mains served | 3. dessert decision | 4. open check | 5. suspected duplicate | 6. service owner | 7. exception note | 8. read-back confirmation | 9. status change | 10. continuity of service

Hand over two different tables

F Say it

At 9:00, Noor takes tables 8 and 9. Table 8 has mains served and no dessert order. Table 9 has an open check with a possible duplicate tea charge under lead review. Noor accepts both follow-ups.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Noor / dessert / open / tea

08

Outgoing server: "Table 8 needs a ¹ _____ follow-up."

Incoming server: "Table 9's check remains ² _____."

Outgoing server: "The queried item is ³ _____."

Incoming server: "The receiving server is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. dessert | 2. open | 3. tea | 4. Noor

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming seats and order details

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which seat has not chosen?

C. Seat three

The brief explicitly leaves seat three's dish undecided.

2. Which request already belongs to the salad?

B. Dressing separately

Seat two requested salad with the dressing served separately.

3. What should Lena clarify before sending?

D. Which dish should have no onions

The onion request has no clear dish or seat reference when first heard.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which clarification is most useful?

A. Which dish should have no onions?

The question asks for the missing dish reference without blame or unsupported changes.

2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?

D. No onions, dressing on the side

Sam confirms the onion request for the salad, which already has separate dressing.

3. Which statement preserves the pending choice?

D. Seat three is still deciding.

The brief leaves the third choice open rather than establishing a dish or cancellation.

4. What does the onion request establish medically?

A. No allergy diagnosis or report by itself

A requested omission alone does not supply an allergy report or a safety conclusion.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming seats and order details

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. modifier. Turn 2. The modifier changes the salad order; Sam identifies which dish the no-onions instruction belongs to.

2. on the side. Turn 4. On the side is the usual serving phrase for dressing provided separately rather than mixed into the salad.

3. pending choice. Turn 6. A pending choice has not been made; it is not a cancellation or permission to invent a dish.

4. read-back. Turn 8. A read-back repeats recorded details aloud so the guest can correct an error before the order is sent.

5. seat reference. Turn 10. The seat reference links the salad and its two requests to seat two, keeping the pasta unchanged.

6. order ticket. Turn 12. The order ticket carries preparation details to the kitchen, so the dish and its modifiers must remain linked.

7. covers. Turn 14. Covers counts diners; three covers does not mean that three main-course choices have already been confirmed.

8. omission. Turn 16. An omission is a requested removal; here it means leaving onions out of the salad, without an allergy report.

9. confirmation. Turn 18. Confirmation establishes that the repeated order details are correct; it should include the actual third choice when made.

10. send the order. Turn 20. Send the order means transmit the confirmed details; Sam asks Lena to check the remaining choice before doing so.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. fish

Server: "The lemon request belongs to the fish."

The clarification specifically attaches the separate lemon to the grilled fish.

2. two

Guest: "That is seat two."

The guest ordering grilled fish is in seat two.

3. unchanged

Server: "The tomato soup remains unchanged."

No modification to the soup is supplied in the facts.

4. covers

Guest: "There are two covers."

Covers counts diners, and this table has two diners.

02 Briefing and language checks

Explaining menu choices and prices

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is the steak set price?

D. \$29

The \$24 base plus the \$5 steak supplement equals \$29.

2. Which item is included in both steak options?

B. Potatoes

Both the steak set and a la carte steak include potatoes.

3. What is not supplied?

D. A separate dessert price

The case gives the set comparison, not a standalone dessert price.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which calculation is correct?

B. \$24 + \$5 = \$29 for the steak set

The supplement is added to the set base, not to the a la carte price.

2. Which comparison is complete?

D. \$29 with dessert versus \$27 without dessert; both include potatoes.

This comparison gives the actual prices and distinguishes shared and different inclusions.

3. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?

B. The restaurant's standalone dessert price is \$2.

A difference between bundled offers does not establish the separate selling price of a component.

4. Which recommendation avoids pressure?

B. If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.

The recommendation uses the supplied price and inclusion difference without inventing benefits or removing choice.

02 Conversation answers

Explaining menu choices and prices

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. base price.** Turn 2. The base price is the set's starting amount before the listed five-dollar steak supplement is added.
- 2. supplement.** Turn 4. A supplement is an addition to the stated base, not a replacement price or the cost of the whole dish.
- 3. a la carte.** Turn 6. A la carte identifies an individual menu item rather than the main-and-dessert set being compared.
- 4. inclusion.** Turn 8. An inclusion is covered by the quoted option; potatoes are included in both steak choices in this menu.
- 5. price difference.** Turn 10. The price difference is twenty-nine minus twenty-seven, or two dollars between these two specific options.
- 6. standalone price.** Turn 12. The standalone price applies to a dessert bought separately; the two-dollar bundle difference does not establish it.
- 7. value comparison.** Turn 14. A value comparison considers both price and inclusions, allowing the guest to decide whether the dessert matters.
- 8. main-and-dessert set.** Turn 16. The main-and-dessert set names the included courses; coffee is not supplied as an inclusion in this comparison.
- 9. price basis.** Turn 18. The price basis specifies what each quoted amount covers, avoiding unsupported claims about other items or charges.
- 10. guest choice.** Turn 20. The guest choice must be confirmed explicitly; discussing an option at length does not authorize ordering it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. twenty-four

Server: "The fish set costs twenty-four dollars."

Twenty dollars plus the four-dollar supplement equals twenty-four dollars.

2. twenty-two

Guest: "Fish alone is twenty-two dollars."

The stated a la carte price is twenty-two dollars without dessert.

3. rice

Server: "Both options include rice."

Rice is included in both options under the supplied menu.

4. unspecified

Guest: "The separate dessert price is unspecified."

The bundle comparison does not supply a standalone dessert price.

03 Briefing and language checks

Receiving an allergy question

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which allergen does Eli report?

D. Sesame

Eli explicitly reports a sesame allergy in the brief.

2. What information does Noor hold?

A. An old menu description

The available description is old and does not establish current ingredients or handling.

3. Who is available before an order is sent?

D. Kitchen lead Cam

Cam is identified as available to discuss the allergy question.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which first response is best?

B. Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.

The response acknowledges the allergy and directs the unresolved questions to current product and preparation checks.

2. Which distinction matters?

B. Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.

A product's intended ingredients do not alone answer how unintended allergen contact is managed.

3. What does Cam's availability establish?

A. A kitchen lead can discuss the query.

Availability provides a responsible contact, not a completed product or preparation assessment.

4. Which guest update is accurate?

D. I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.

The update preserves the unresolved status without offering a false guarantee or inventing a clinical event.

03 Conversation answers

Receiving an allergy question

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. reported allergen. Turn 2. The reported allergen is sesame, which must be communicated accurately rather than replaced by a vague dietary note.

2. current product. Turn 4. The current product is the bun actually used today; an old description cannot establish its present ingredients.

3. cross-contact. Turn 6. Cross-contact concerns unintended allergen introduction, which is not answered solely by the bun's intended ingredient list.

4. ingredient list. Turn 8. The ingredient list must match the actual bun in use, rather than an older menu or another supplied product.

5. handling information. Turn 10. Handling information covers preparation and service conditions, making it distinct from the list of intentional ingredients.

6. product specification. Turn 12. The product specification describes the supplied item; visual appearance alone is not equivalent to verified product information.

7. order hold. Turn 14. The order hold prevents this unresolved allergy query from being treated as an ordinary confirmed order ready for preparation.

8. ingredient verification. Turn 16. Ingredient verification is the actual check of the relevant product; receiving the question does not mean that check is complete.

9. alternative dish. Turn 18. An alternative dish is a separate option requiring appropriate checks, not an automatically safe replacement for the bun.

10. allergy flag. Turn 20. The allergy flag preserves the reported sesame allergy with the relevant order and handoff; it does not itself certify suitability.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. peanut

Server: "The reported allergen is peanut."

Alex reports peanut, which must be repeated without changing the allergen.

2. sauce

Colleague: "The product being questioned is the sauce."

The inquiry concerns the sauce, not an invented bread or dessert.

3. Imani

Server: "The receiving kitchen lead is Imani."

Imani explicitly accepts the query as the named kitchen lead.

4. confirmed

Colleague: "Suitability is not yet confirmed."

Neither current ingredients nor handling has been verified in this exchange.

04 Briefing and language checks

Coordinating courses and delays

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. When were the mains fired?

D. 7:20

The kitchen began the relevant preparation stage at the stated 7:20 time.

2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?

B. Another eight minutes

The estimate is eight additional minutes from the 7:30 update.

3. What is the guests' departure requirement?

C. Leave at 7:50

The guests explicitly need to leave at 7:50.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which timing explanation is accurate?

B. At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.

The explanation anchors the additional eight minutes to the current update and retains uncertainty.

2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?

D. A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time

Arithmetic alone does not establish delivery, eating, payment, or a comfortable departure.

3. Which offer stays within the facts?

A. I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.

A timing discussion is available without inventing an approved operational or financial change.

4. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?

B. Your mains were fired at 7:20.

Fired is internal kitchen shorthand and may need a plain-language explanation of the preparation stage.

04 Conversation answers

Coordinating courses and delays

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. readiness estimate.** Turn 2. The readiness estimate is provisional information about food readiness, not a promise that the whole meal will finish on time.
- 2. remaining time.** Turn 4. Remaining time means additional time from the seven-thirty update, not total time since preparation began.
- 3. fired time.** Turn 6. The fired time records the preparation instruction at seven twenty; it is distinct from the later readiness estimate.
- 4. departure deadline.** Turn 8. The departure deadline is seven fifty, which must be considered separately from preparation or service estimates.
- 5. rush request.** Turn 10. A rush request asks for acceleration; it does not establish accepted priority or a faster confirmed completion time.
- 6. timing discussion.** Turn 12. A timing discussion explores feasible options without claiming that a substitute or cancellation has already been approved.
- 7. table update.** Turn 14. A table update should communicate the actual order status and options, not repeat reassurance unsupported by the kitchen.
- 8. Pickup.** Turn 16. Pickup is the kitchen-to-service handoff, which remains distinct from delivery to the table and completion of the meal.
- 9. timing constraint.** Turn 18. The timing constraint remains the guests' seven-fifty departure; an uncertain kitchen estimate does not remove it.
- 10. completion promise.** Turn 20. A completion promise would commit to a finished outcome; the available estimate does not justify such a guarantee.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 8:10

Server: "The estimate starts from 8:10."

The additional six minutes is anchored to the 8:10 update.

2. 8:16

Guest: "That points to around 8:16."

Adding six minutes to 8:10 produces the approximate 8:16 time.

3. 8:30

Server: "Your departure requirement is 8:30."

The supplied deadline is departure at 8:30, not food readiness.

4. unconfirmed

Guest: "A faster alternative remains unconfirmed."

No quicker option has been confirmed in this scenario.

05 Briefing and language checks

Correcting a dish without blame

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What does the ticket confirm?

B. Vegetable pasta

The ticket supports the guest's vegetable-pasta order rather than the dish delivered.

2. What replacement can Dana offer?

B. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

The kitchen offers the pasta remake, with its timing stated as an estimate.

3. Who must review a bill adjustment?

B. The shift lead

The case assigns bill-adjustment review to the shift lead.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which apology fits the facts?

A. I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.

The apology acknowledges the confirmed mismatch without blaming the guest or inventing a cause.

2. Which offer is authorized?

D. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

Dana may offer the remake, while timing remains estimated and billing requires review.

3. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?

A. I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.

The supplied authority covers referral for review, not a completed adjustment or universal rule.

4. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?

C. After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked

An apology and offer are steps toward resolution, not evidence that the correction and related decisions are complete.

05 Conversation answers

Correcting a dish without blame

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. order mismatch.** Turn 2. The order mismatch is the confirmed difference between vegetable pasta ordered and mushroom risotto delivered.
- 2. remake.** Turn 4. A remake is a newly prepared corrected dish; here the available option is the originally ordered vegetable pasta.
- 3. estimated wait.** Turn 6. An estimated wait is approximate, so Dana must not turn it into a guaranteed exact arrival time.
- 4. bill adjustment.** Turn 8. A bill adjustment is a separate financial decision that the shift lead must review under the supplied authority.
- 5. comp.** Turn 10. A comp means an item provided without charge under authorization; the available remake offer does not establish that approval.
- 6. cause.** Turn 12. The cause of the wrong delivery is not supplied; a correct ticket does not identify which person or stage caused the error.
- 7. follow-up check.** Turn 14. A follow-up check verifies that the agreed correction actually occurs, including delivery of the correct dish to the guest.
- 8. acceptance.** Turn 16. Acceptance is the guest's agreement to the proposed remedy; Alex explicitly has not given it yet.
- 9. shift lead.** Turn 18. The shift lead is the named role responsible for reviewing a bill adjustment, distinct from Dana's replacement-offer authority.
- 10. resolution status.** Turn 20. Resolution status tracks actual agreement and completion; the current state is an offer and pending bill review, not closure.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. lentil

Server: "The ticket confirms lentil soup."

Lentil is the ordered soup confirmed by the ticket.

2. tomato

Guest: "The delivered soup was tomato."

Tomato is the soup actually delivered in this scenario.

3. seven

Server: "The estimated remake wait is seven minutes."

Seven minutes is the stated estimate, not a guaranteed arrival time.

4. Noor

Guest: "The bill question goes to Noor."

Noor is named as the lead responsible for reviewing an adjustment.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining and splitting a bill

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the stated bill total?

A. \$72 with all listed charges included

The scenario supplies a seventy-two-dollar total with its listed charges already included.

2. What does three ways need to clarify?

A. Equal payments or separate checks by item

The phrase can refer to different allocation methods even with three diners.

3. What is each equal share?

D. \$24

Seventy-two divided by three equals twenty-four dollars per equal share.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?

B. Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?

The question presents the two supported methods without guessing the group's intention.

2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?

D. \$72 divided by 3 is \$24 each.

Three times twenty-four equals the full seventy-two-dollar total.

3. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?

A. An agreed allocation of items and shared charges

Item-based amounts depend on who is assigned each charge, not simply the diner count.

4. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?

D. The intended allocation, not completed payment

Agreeing the method precedes processing and does not prove that any payment has been completed.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining and splitting a bill

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. equal shares.** Turn 2. Equal shares divide the total into the same amount for each diner, unlike separate checks based on individual items.
- 2. bill total.** Turn 4. The bill total is the stated seventy-two dollars, including all listed charges in this fictional scenario.
- 3. item allocation.** Turn 6. Item allocation assigns charges to the relevant diners; their amounts cannot be calculated from the diner count alone.
- 4. allocation method.** Turn 8. The allocation method is the group's agreed way of dividing the bill, which the server should not choose for them.
- 5. split payment.** Turn 10. The split payment applies three agreed twenty-four-dollar payments to one seventy-two-dollar bill; it does not change the total.
- 6. card terminal.** Turn 12. The card terminal displays the payment being submitted; checking its amount helps prevent an incorrect full-bill charge.
- 7. listed charge.** Turn 14. A listed charge is already part of the supplied total; splitting the payment does not justify charging it a second time.
- 8. payment receipt.** Turn 16. A payment receipt records an actual transaction; it should not be represented as proof of payment before processing occurs.
- 9. outstanding balance.** Turn 18. The outstanding balance is what remains unpaid after actual recorded payments, not an amount inferred solely from the agreed split.
- 10. payment confirmation.** Turn 20. Payment confirmation establishes the relevant completed transaction status, which remains separate from agreeing a payment plan.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. equal

Server: "You have chosen equal payments."

The diners explicitly choose equal payments rather than item-based checks.

2. twenty-four

Guest: "Each share is twenty-four dollars."

Ninety-six divided by four equals twenty-four dollars per diner.

3. ninety-six

Server: "The full total remains ninety-six dollars."

Changing the allocation does not change the stated ninety-six-dollar total.

4. processed

Guest: "The payments are not yet processed."

The scenario confirms the method but supplies no completed payment.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Agreeing on clearing and shared service

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Why is the empty plate still needed?

C. The diner is using it for another portion.

The brief states that the diner will use the plate for more shared food.

2. What remains in the shared dish?

B. Vegetables

The shared vegetable dish still contains food in this case.

3. What may the team offer?

B. Extra sharing plates

Extra sharing plates are available to offer, while clearing still needs clarification.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which question is most appropriate?

D. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

The question checks the actual plate and allows the diner to keep using it.

2. What does the empty plate establish?

B. Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed

The plate is empty but remains in use for another portion.

3. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?

C. Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.

The instruction preserves active items while allowing a specific clearing-permission check.

4. How should cultural differences be handled?

D. Ask the individual table about its preference.

A direct, respectful question establishes the actual preference without relying on group stereotypes.

07 Conversation answers

Agreeing on clearing and shared service

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. active item. Turn 2. The active item is the empty plate still needed for another portion; its empty surface does not make it finished.

2. service cue. Turn 4. A service cue may suggest a need, but the empty plate is ambiguous and requires checking with the guest.

3. clearing permission. Turn 6. Clearing permission is the guest's agreement to remove the specific item, which should be obtained before taking it.

4. guest preference. Turn 8. The guest preference is the actual table's request, not a rule inferred from nationality or an empty plate.

5. sharing plate. Turn 10. A sharing plate can help guests take portions from a shared dish, but the extra item remains an offer.

6. shared dish. Turn 12. The shared dish still contains vegetables for continued service, so one empty individual plate does not establish permission to remove it.

7. finished item. Turn 14. A finished item can be removed with appropriate agreement without treating the entire table as finished with the meal.

8. table reset. Turn 16. A table reset prepares the setting for new guests; clearing one agreed item during a meal is a different stage.

9. meal pace. Turn 18. Meal pace is the guests' eating rhythm, which the team can respect by checking needs instead of rushing active items away.

10. Unobtrusive service. Turn 20. Unobtrusive service meets the real need with minimal disruption, combining a specific question with respectful follow-through.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. needed

Server: "The empty plate is still needed."

The diner needs the plate for another portion of shared dessert.

2. dessert

Colleague: "The shared dish contains dessert."

The remaining food in the supplied shared dish is dessert.

3. offered

Server: "Extra small plates can be offered."

The plates are an available offer, not an automatic addition.

4. given

Colleague: "Clearing permission has not been given."

The scenario supplies no guest permission to remove the active plate.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over a live section

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is table 4's meal stage?

C. Mains served; dessert not ordered

The brief states that the mains are served while dessert remains unchosen.

2. What is table 5's check status?

B. Open

Table 5 has an open check while the coffee query remains under review.

3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?

C. The shift lead

The shift lead is already reviewing the query, but no result is supplied.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?

C. Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.

The message preserves the known meal stage and identifies the unfinished dessert follow-up.

2. Which coffee description is justified?

C. A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review

The brief supplies a pending query, not a confirmed error, motive, or adjustment.

3. Which ownership arrangement is clear?

C. Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.

The arrangement distinguishes guest communication from the decision authority and gives both work streams an owner.

4. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?

A. The actual relevant payment and closure process

A staffing handover does not establish that the bill has been paid or closed.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over a live section

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. handover.** Turn 2. The handover transfers relevant table information and accepted responsibility, not just a list of numbers.
- 2. mains served.** Turn 4. Mains served means the main dishes have reached table four; it does not establish that dessert has been ordered.
- 3. dessert decision.** Turn 6. The dessert decision is the guest's pending choice; the incoming server should ask rather than treat it as an existing order.
- 4. open check.** Turn 8. The open check remains unsettled in the relevant process; the handover does not supply payment or closure.
- 5. suspected duplicate.** Turn 10. A suspected duplicate is a possible repeated charge under review, not a confirmed error or approved adjustment.
- 6. service owner.** Turn 12. The service owner takes responsibility for guest-facing follow-up while the shift lead remains responsible for the charge decision.
- 7. exception note.** Turn 14. The exception note preserves the unusual unresolved coffee query alongside the table's ordinary service and payment status.
- 8. read-back confirmation.** Turn 16. Read-back confirmation checks that the receiving server has matched each table with the correct unfinished task.
- 9. status change.** Turn 18. A status change must reflect an actual new event or decision, not an assumption caused by the handover.
- 10. continuity of service.** Turn 20. Continuity of service keeps guest needs attended to across the staffing change without losing unresolved work.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. dessert

Outgoing server: "Table 8 needs a dessert follow-up."

Dessert is not ordered, so Noor needs to check that choice.

2. open

Incoming server: "Table 9's check remains open."

No payment or closure is established for table nine.

3. tea

Outgoing server: "The queried item is tea."

The possible duplicate concerns tea rather than an invented coffee charge.

4. Noor

Incoming server: "The receiving server is Noor."

Noor explicitly accepts both follow-ups in this handover.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming seats and order details

Clarify the dish: Which dish should have no onions?

Read back seat two: Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side.

Ask briefly: May I check one detail before I send this?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Explaining menu choices and prices

Introduce the set: The lunch set includes a main and dessert.

Give the combined price: That makes the steak set \$29.

Calculate the difference: The set is two dollars more than steak alone.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Receiving an allergy question

Acknowledge the disclosure: Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy.

Pause the order: I will check before sending an order.

Include handling: We also need the relevant cross-contact information.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Coordinating courses and delays

Acknowledge the wait: I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected.

Translate the estimate: That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time.

Separate stages: Kitchen readiness and arrival at the table are different stages.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Correcting a dish without blame

Acknowledge the mismatch: You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto.

Avoid blaming the guest: You do not need to explain the order again.

Keep timing honest: I cannot guarantee an exact arrival time.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining and splitting a bill

Clarify the request: Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?

Explain the other method: For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person.

Confirm the selected method: You would like three equal payments, correct?

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Agreeing on clearing and shared service

Ask about an item: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

Offer practical help: Would extra sharing plates be useful?

Keep the question narrow: Ask about the specific item rather than the whole meal.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over a live section

Open the transfer: It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5.

Name the first follow-up: Please check whether table 4 wants dessert.

Name the decision owner: The shift lead is reviewing the charge query.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

a la carte order a la carte	14
acceptance confirm acceptance	42
accepted follow-up record an accepted follow-up	69
accompaniment describe the accompaniment	6
active item leave active items	60
additional charge identify an additional charge	15
allergen identify the allergen	23
allergen matrix consult the current allergen matrix	23
allergic reaction follow allergic-reaction procedures	24
allergy flag enter an allergy flag	24
allocation method clarify the allocation method	50
alternative dish check an alternative dish	24
apology offer a clear apology	41
approval limit observe an approval limit	42
authorization check payment authorization	51
availability check availability	15
base price state the base price	14
bill adjustment request a bill adjustment	42
bill total confirm the bill total	50
blame avoid unsupported blame	41
bottleneck identify the bottleneck	33
busser coordinate with the busser	59
card terminal present the card terminal	51
cause avoid guessing the cause	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

charge review request a charge review	69
check bring the check	50
clear ask before clearing	59
clearing permission obtain clearing permission	60
closed check verify a closed check	69
comp obtain approval for a comp	42
completion promise avoid an unsupported completion promise	33
confirmation obtain confirmation	6
confirmed mismatch state the confirmed mismatch	41
contingency verify a contingency	33
continuity of service maintain continuity of service	69
coordinated service arrange coordinated service	33
course enter the main course	6
course pacing adjust course pacing	32
cover serve three covers	5
crockery handle the crockery	60
cross-contact assess allergen cross-contact	23
current product identify the current product	23
cutlery replace the cutlery	59
daily special explain the daily special	15
decision owner identify the decision owner	69
delivered dish identify the delivered dish	41
departure deadline acknowledge the departure deadline	32
dessert decision follow up the dessert decision	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

dietary requirement clarify a dietary requirement	6
discount authorize a discount	42
duplicate charge investigate a duplicate charge	51
elapsed time calculate elapsed time	33
emergency response activate the emergency response	24
equal share calculate an equal share	50
estimated wait explain the estimated wait	42
exception note preserve an exception note	69
exclusion clarify an exclusion	14
expeditor check with the expeditor	32
finished item identify finished items	60
fire fire the mains	32
fired time confirm the fired time	32
flatware provide clean flatware	60
follow-through ensure follow-through	69
follow-up check make a follow-up check	42
food allergy report a food allergy	23
food runner brief the food runner	59
garnish identify the garnish	6
glassware collect finished glassware	60
gratuity clarify a gratuity	51
guest choice confirm the guest choice	15
guest preference confirm the guest preference	60
handling information obtain handling information	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

handover complete the section handover	68
handover gap prevent a handover gap	69
handover time state the handover time	68
inclusion compare the inclusions	14
inclusive price explain the inclusive price	14
incoming server confirm the incoming server	68
inconvenience acknowledge the inconvenience	41
ingredient list check the current ingredient list	23
ingredient verification complete ingredient verification	24
item allocation confirm the item allocation	50
itemized bill review the itemized bill	50
itemized total present an itemized total	15
kitchen lead consult the kitchen lead	24
listed charge verify a listed charge	50
live table identify live tables	68
main choose a main	6
main-and-dessert set choose the main-and-dessert set	14
mains served confirm mains served	68
meal pace respect the meal pace	60
menu description read the menu description	15
menu pairing explain the menu pairing	15
modifier attach a modifier	5
omission confirm the omission	5
on the fly request a dish on the fly	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

on the side serve dressing on the side	5
open check monitor the open check	68
optional extra describe an optional extra	15
order hold maintain the order hold	24
order mismatch acknowledge the order mismatch	41
order pad update the order pad	5
order sequence preserve the order sequence	6
order ticket read the order ticket	5
ordered dish confirm the ordered dish	41
outgoing server brief the outgoing server	68
outstanding balance confirm the outstanding balance	51
partial payment record a partial payment	51
pass collect from the pass	32
payment confirmation check payment confirmation	51
payment method confirm the payment method	51
payment receipt provide a payment receipt	51
pending choice keep a choice pending	6
pending query carry forward a pending query	68
pickup coordinate pickup	32
place setting maintain the place setting	59
point of sale enter the order at the point of sale	5
portion describe the portion	15
pre-bus pre-bus discreetly	59
preference record a preference	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

preparation area verify the preparation area	23
preparation request confirm the preparation request	6
preparation stage confirm the preparation stage	32
price basis state the price basis	15
price clarification give a price clarification	15
price difference calculate the price difference	14
priority confirm priority	33
product specification verify the product specification	23
product substitution check for a product substitution	24
read-back give a read-back	5
read-back confirmation obtain read-back confirmation	69
readiness estimate give a readiness estimate	32
recipe check the current recipe	23
recipe change verify a recipe change	24
reconciliation complete payment reconciliation	51
refund process an approved refund	42
remaining time state the remaining time	32
remake request a remake	41
remedy offer an available remedy	42
replacement offer explain the replacement offer	41
reported allergen repeat the reported allergen	24
resolution status confirm the resolution status	42
rounding explain rounding	51
rush request check a rush request	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

seat number confirm the seat number	5
seat reference clarify the seat reference	5
section take over a section	68
send the order send the order	6
separate check prepare separate checks	50
service charge explain a service charge	50
service cue clarify a service cue	60
service owner name the service owner	69
service recovery manage service recovery	41
service station organize the service station	59
service window discuss the service window	32
serving utensil provide a serving utensil	59
sesame flag a sesame allergy	23
set menu explain the set menu	14
settle the bill settle the bill	51
shared dish leave the shared dish	59
shared equipment check shared equipment	23
shared item allocate a shared item	50
sharing plate offer a sharing plate	59
shift lead consult the shift lead	42
side dish include a side dish	14
side plate offer a side plate	59
sideboard restock the sideboard	59
split payment arrange a split payment	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

standalone price verify the standalone price	14
starter order a starter	6
status change communicate a status change	69
substitution check a substitution	5
subtotal distinguish the subtotal	50
supplement apply the steak supplement	14
supplier label inspect the supplier label	23
suspected duplicate review a suspected duplicate	68
table number check the table number	5
table reset begin an authorized table reset	60
table status summarize the table status	68
table turnover manage table turnover	60
table update deliver a table update	33
ticket check perform a ticket check	41
ticket time check the ticket time	32
timing constraint clarify the timing constraint	33
timing discussion offer a timing discussion	33
unobtrusive service provide unobtrusive service	60
unresolved item track the unresolved item	69
unsupported assurance avoid an unsupported assurance	24
update point agree an update point	33
upgrade explain the upgrade	14
value comparison make a value comparison	15
void record an authorized void	42

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Waiters and Waitresses.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for order-taking, kitchen communication, guest service, clearing, and payment work. The original cases do not represent employment statistics. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Allergies.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for allergen and cross-contact terminology. The allergy dialogue never certifies a dish or substitutes for current ingredient and preparation checks. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Code 2026.

[Open the original source](#)

A model food code offered for jurisdictional adoption, not an automatically universal restaurant rule. Consult applicable current local requirements. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All restaurants, prices, guests, and service events are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, or payment compliance. Follow current local law and actual allergy, food-handling, payment, and emergency procedures. Menu descriptions do not establish allergen safety. Do not delay urgent help for a routine service conversation.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)